

# A 168-Unit Bronx Filing Shows Development Is Alive Where the Math Works

Permits for 78 West 180th Street reveal that new supply is still flowing to outer-borough infill sites with transit and lower land costs.

The most important number in the permit filing for 78 West 180th Street is not 168 units or 109,718 square feet. It is the address itself. University Heights, The Bronx, served by the 4 train at Burnside Avenue, is not the kind of submarket that makes headlines when capital is scarce. That is precisely why this filing matters. Development in New York City has not stopped.

It has concentrated where the underwriting pencil still sharpens: lower land basis, reliable transit access, and rental demand that does not depend on a return to peak office occupancy. This project, filed by Yitzi Salamon with architect Nikolai Katz, fits that pattern exactly. The 13-story, 123-foot building will deliver 168 residences averaging 653 square feet. That unit size points to rental apartments, not condos.

The developer is betting on cash flow, not a sales exit. The 18 parking spaces are minimal, consistent with a transit-oriented site where the 4 train provides the real amenity. What this filing reveals about capital availability is more interesting than the building itself. Construction financing for outer-borough multifamily has not dried up. It has become more expensive, more selective, and more dependent on sponsor track record.

A permit filing at this scale means the sponsor has either secured equity commitments or is confident enough in the project economics to spend on soft costs and architectural drawings. That confidence is not blind.

It is based on a simple calculation: land in University Heights costs a fraction of what it costs in Manhattan or even parts of western Queens, and rents, while lower, have shown steady growth as the borough absorbs new supply. The market signal here is about bifurcation.

High-end Manhattan condo towers and large-scale mixed-use projects face a tougher financing environment because their break-even rents or sales prices require a demand profile that is uncertain. Mid-scale Bronx rentals do not. Their tenants are already in the market, paying rent, and looking for units that meet modern standards. The risk is not demand. It is construction cost overruns and interest rate carry during the build. Who benefits from this filing?

The immediate beneficiaries are the sponsor and the architect. The broader beneficiaries are lenders willing to finance transit-oriented infill development in the Bronx, and the tenants who will eventually occupy units that add to the borough's rental stock. Who is exposed? Any developer trying to build a similar project on a higher-cost site without the same demand fundamentals. The gap between projects that pencil and projects that do not is widening.



The market should watch two things next. First, whether this project secures a construction loan and from what lender type. A bank loan would signal that regional and community banks are still active in this lane. A private credit loan would confirm that non-bank lenders are filling the gap for smaller, well-located projects. Second, watch the lease-up velocity when the building delivers.

If 168 units in University Heights lease quickly at projected rents, it will validate the thesis that outer-borough infill is one of the few development strategies that still works in this cycle. A permit filing is not a building. But it is a bet. And this bet says that development capital has not left New York City. It has just become very specific about where it will go.

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We work across acquisitions, refinancings, recapitalizations, and development projects, with a focus on clear strategy, credible execution, and capital that fits the deal.

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